On the other hand Sa‘īd in the name of justice and gratitude had rejected their offer to incur any harm to Babur. He appealed to serve under Babur’s command, where they could maintain their friendship for their mutual benefit. The decision was finalized when Babur responded to an urgent plea for assistance from Haider’s uncle in Andijan by dispatching him there. It was on the May 13 of AD 1511 (the 14th of Safar) that Haider was appointed as a Khān and began his journey. Most of the Moghūls accompanied him, although not all of them, as records indicate that even individuals like Ayūb Begchīk from Merv continued to be associated with Babur on several later occasions.

d) Babur’s use of the phrase ‘I made him Khān’[*] echoes a similar appointment mentioned earlier,[†] where Abu-sa’id of Yunas was appointed as Khān of the Moghūls. In both cases, it appears that the Tīmūrid Mīrzā appointed the Chaghatāī Khān as the leader of the Moghūls.

e) First attempt on Ḥiṣār

Following a brief stay in Qūndūz, Babur proceeded towards Ḥiṣār, where the Aūzbeg sulṭāns Mahdī and Ḥamza were situated. They ventured out to Wakhsh with the intention of meeting him, but due to a misunderstanding, no confrontation occurred, and both parties withdrew.[‡]

f) Intercourse between Babur and Ismā’īl Ṣafawī

While Babur was residing in Qūndūz, his sister Khān-zāda arrived there safely, escorted by the Shāh’s troops. This was after the battle of Merv, in which her successive husbands, Shaybāni and Sayyid Hādī, had perished. Accompanying her was an emissary from Isma’il, extending gestures of friendship and goodwill with the aim of soliciting Persian support for Babur. In response to these courtesies, Babur dispatched Mīrzā Khān with expressions of gratitude and gifts. According to Haidar, Mīrzā Khān also conveyed assurances of their good intentions and a request for military aid. The reception was warm, and the request for assistance was granted, albeit under stringent conditions, as later events would reveal.

31 March of AD 1511 to 9 March of AD 1512

a) Second attempt on Ḥiṣār

In this year, Babur once more advanced towards Ḥiṣār. He established his position at the Pul-i-sangīn (Stone Bridge) on the Sūrkh-āb, a place where his ancestor Tīmūr had previously achieved remarkable success against formidable odds. He remained stationed there for a month, awaiting reinforcements. On the